IT Certifications
Why? What? When? How?

aws certified AI Practitioner FOUNDATIONAL

CISCO CERTIFIED CCNA

CompTIA Security+ CERTIFICATION Plus Series

CTT™ Certified Technical Trainer

CISSP®

Red Hat Red Hat Certified Specialist Security: Linux

Red Hat Red Hat Certified Architect

Why do employers want you certified?

Required for job role

Marketing company services

Reduced outsource costs

Faster hiring and onboarding and lower turnover

DoD Manual 8140.03

Cyberspace Workforce Qualification and Management Program

DoD Directive 8140

- Replaced 8570 in 2023
- Mandates certification for personnel with privileged access to DoD information systems
- Applies to military personnel, government civilians, and contractors.
- Roles are categorized by 3 technical levels
- Entry level includes CompTIA A+, CCNA
- Intermediate Level includes CompTIA Security+

Benefits for candidates:

82%
gained confidence to explore and pursue new job opportunities

63%
received or expected a job promotion after certification

32%
received salary increases

Benefits for organizations:

79%
of certified employees produce higher quality work

76%
show increased ability to innovate and enhance processes

70%
demonstrate improved productivity on the job

2025 Value of IT Certification Candidate Report https://go.pearsonvue.com/voc

Certifications On the Rise

93% of respondents reported having at least one certification, nearly a 6% increase from last year, and reported benefits like improved work quality (60%), engagement (48%), and productivity (43%).

Economic Impact of Training

97% of IT decision-makers say certified staff add value to their organizations, with 22% estimating that value at $30,000 or more. These professionals close skill gaps, solve problems faster, and give their employers a competitive edge.

Skill Gaps Hurt Business Outcomes

Two-thirds of decision-makers report skill gaps on their teams, with nearly as many forecasting them in the next few years. The cost of skill gaps burden teams, increasing their stress and hampering their ability to meet business objectives.

2024 report: https://www.globalknowledge.com/us-en/content/salary-report/it-skills-and-salary-report/

Taking a Certification Exam

- Preparation
  - Choose the right cert for your needs and training experience
  - There are different styles of testing
  - Study, practice, apply
- Purchasing and Scheduling
- The Day of…
- Getting your results
- Retake options

Choosing the right certification

- What are your goals?
- What are your Interests?
- Research your options
  - Availability, reputation, recognition
  - General or product specific
  - Test styles, costs, etc
- Think long term
  - What is the re certification process?

https://www.globalknowledge.com/us-en/resources/resource-library/articles/how-to-select-the-right-certification-for-you/

Styles

- Multi-guess
- Simulations
- Live Labs (Virtual Machines)
- Mixed
- 100% Hands-on

Multi-guess

- Select best answer, select all that apply, matching
- Scenarios with multiple questions
  - Performance based questions
- Watch for negatives
- Some are adaptive

- Prepare with flashcards (terminology) and practice tests
- Value can be limited by “exam dumping”

Simulations

- Often included with multi-guess computer based exams
  - Performance based questions
- Enter full commands
- May not have all the shortcut keys of live environment
  - Tab complete
  - In app help
- Often no access to the documentation
- Prepare with practice and repetition. Some simulators are available for learning and practice.

Hands-on Live Labs

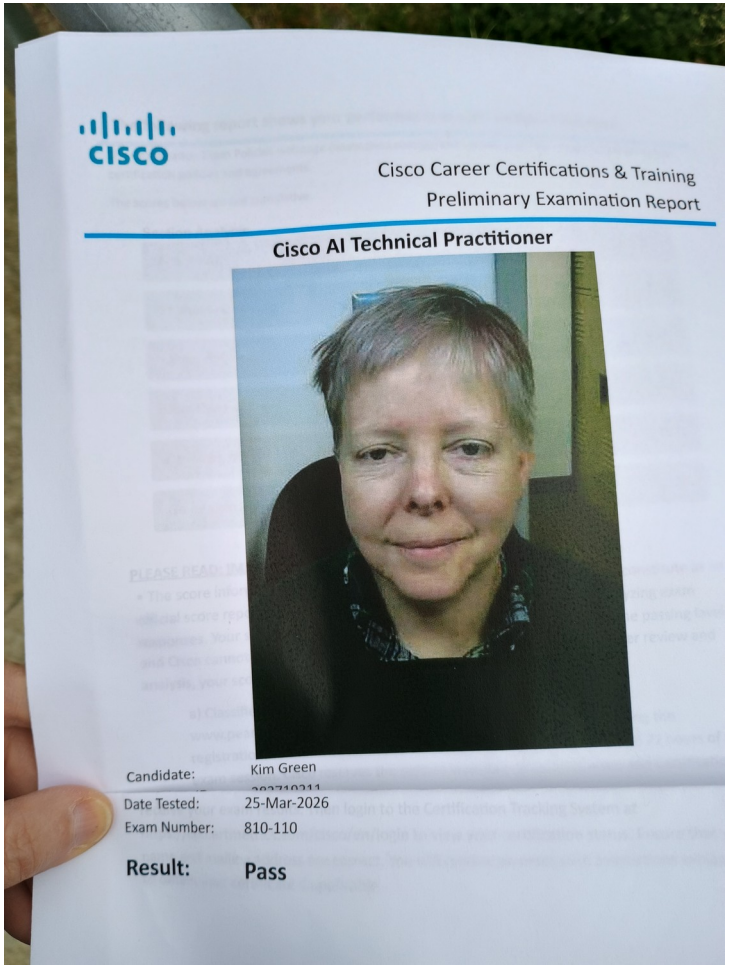
- May be performance based questions mixed with simulations and multi-guess (CompTia, GIAC)
- Some exams are 100% hands-on
- Example: Red Hat exams
  - Test end result, not method
  - Can use graphical or CLI tools as available
  - Red Hat even includes standard documentation and some ability to install software that is included with the product.
- If documentation is provided – know the docs!
  - What to memorize vs what to know where to find examples

The Night before to the Day of...

- Read instructions on what to bring and what not to bring.
- Be on time (early even) and have the required ID.
- Sleep can help more than last minute cramming.
- Same with relaxation exercises. Breath.
- Can be at a site or from home depending on the exam
  - Home based exams often require a camera for remote monitoring and a clean, quiet space with no other people present.
  - Test centers can be cold. Dress comfortably and in layers.

Results

- Computer based at testing site usually provide a score immediately. These are usually multi-guess and mixed styles.
- Performance based exams are often graded after and scores reported by email withing a few days.
- Pass/Fail and sometimes a number score – points or percent
- Some break down by list of topics or objectives



cisco

Cisco Career Certifications & Training
Preliminary Examination Report

Cisco AI Technical Practitioner

Candidate: Kim Green
Date Tested: 25-Mar-2026
Exam Number: 810-110

Result: Pass

The results of your recent EX432 Red Hat Certified Specialist in OpenShift Advanced Cluster Management Exam are reported below.

Exam domain number: 7
Passing score: 210
Your score: 257

Result: PASS

Congratulations -- you have earned the Red Hat Certified Specialist in OpenShift Advanced Cluster Management certification.

Performance on exam objectives:

OBJECTIVE: SCORE
Manage and deploy Red Hat Advanced Cluster Management for Kubernetes (RHACM): 100%
Manage clusters by using Red Hat Advanced Cluster Management for Kubernetes (RHACM): 100%
Configure access control for multi-cluster management: 100%
Deploy and manage policies for multiple clusters: 100%
Manage the RHACM observability service: 100%
Use Kustomize to manage resources: 0%
Manage multi-cluster application lifecycle using GitOps practices: 50%
Manage Virtualization Operator: 100%

The results of your recent EX288 Red Hat Certified OpenShift Application Developer Exam are reported below.

Exam domain number: 19
Passing score: 210
Your score: 162

Result: NO PASS

Performance on exam objectives:

OBJECTIVE: SCORE
Work with Red Hat OpenShift Container Platform: 78%
Deploy multi-container applications: 100%
Work with container images in OpenShift Container Platform: 0%
Troubleshoot application builds and deployment issues: 60%
Work with image streams: 100%
Work with configuration maps and secrets: 75%
Work with the source-to-image (S2I) framework: 17%
Work with templates: 50%
Work with OpenShift Pipelines: 20%

Please contact us within 30 days if you have any questions, concerns or suggestions about your exam or certification at

Learn from the experience

- Pass or fail, you can learn from the experience and results
- Some exam purchase options include a retake in the cost if you fail the first time

Study tips

- Terminology
  - Understand the question, especially for performance objectives
  - Flashcards
- Practice
  - Repeat training materials labs
  - Repetition of common commands and options
  - Looking up specifics in the documentation
- Apply
  - Work with the product outside of the training materials

SEE ONE

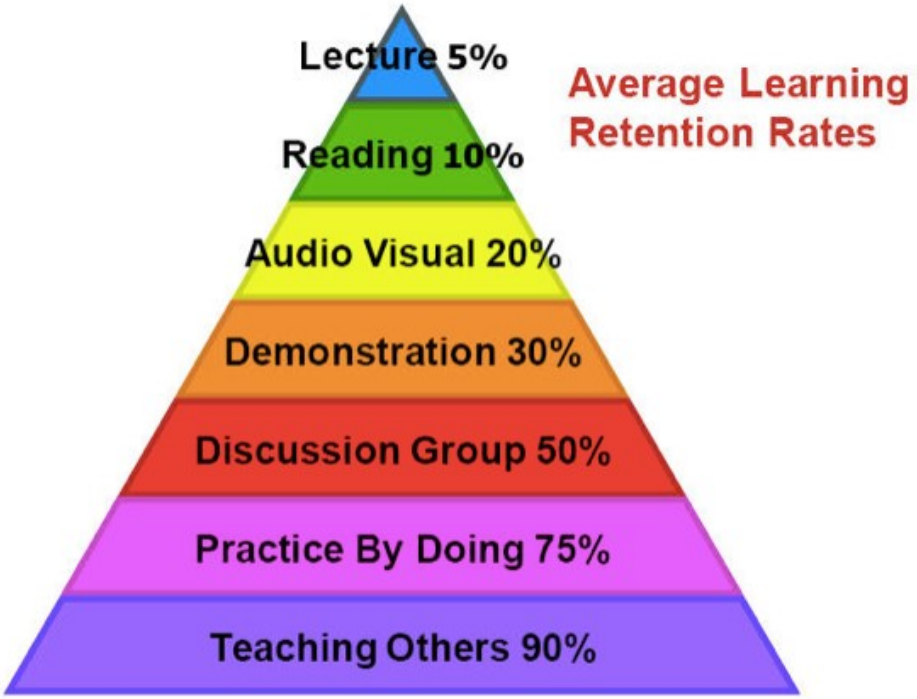
- Watch how it's done well. Learn the standard.

DO ONE

- Try it yourself. Build confidence through action.

TEACH ONE

- Share it with someone else. Teaching cements your own mastery.



Source: National Training Laboratories, Bethel, Maine

Thank You!

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